

Review 1

Speaking and Vocabulary

A Talk with a partner. Answer these questions about the Speaking Module of the IELTS exam.

1. How many parts are there in the Speaking Module?
2. How long does each part last?
3. What happens in each part? How are the parts different from one another?

B Look at some comments made by students who are studying for the IELTS exam. Tick the ones that you most agree with.

- ☐ 'I think the first part of the speaking exam, when the examiner asks about your life, is quite easy. It's more difficult to think about what to say when you have to read a card.'
- ☐ 'I prefer the second part of the speaking because reading the card gives you ideas and you have time to plan what to say.'
- ☐ 'I don't like the third part of the speaking exam. You have to think quickly and you don't always have the words to express your opinion.'
- ☐ 'The third part of the Speaking Module is the most challenging but the most interesting. I can tell the examiner what I think – not just give him facts.'
- ☐ 'I try to learn as much vocabulary as I can – especially very common expressions. I think having the words is more important than being perfectly accurate in the speaking exam.'
- ☐ 'When I learn new words, I make sure I can pronounce them correctly. If the examiner can't understand what I say, he will get bored and give me a low grade.'
- ☐ 'It's important that you keep it simple. You should only say what you know you can say. If you don't know how to use the present perfect continuous, you shouldn't try to.'

C Write two comments of your own. Then compare with a partner.

D Write important words and phrases that you have learnt so far under each heading.

family and friends

stages of life

learning

expressing a preference

my words and phrases

work and jobs

achievement and success

thinking

Listening

A Answer these questions with a partner.

1. How many parts are there in the Listening Module of the IELTS exam?
2. How many questions do you think there are in total?
3. How are the various parts of the Listening Module different from one another?
4. Does the Listening Module gradually become more challenging?
5. What type of tasks have you practised so far?

B Tick the statement about listening in each pair that is true for you.

1. A I often understand the gist of a talk or conversation but not the details.
B I can often hear details, but don't really understand what the people are talking about.
2. A It's easier to listen to just one person giving a talk.
B I prefer listening to a conversation between two or more people. The context is clearer.
3. A I don't like writing when I'm trying to listen. I prefer it when I need to circle a letter or tick a box.
B I don't mind writing when I'm listening if it's just a number or a name that is spelt for me.
4. A It's difficult to catch the words when I have to listen and complete notes.
B I can usually catch the words I need, but then I don't have time to write them.
5. A I don't like looking at maps or diagrams when I'm trying to listen.
B I like tasks with a map or diagram because the context is clearer.
6. A My listening has improved, and now I answer more questions correctly.
B My listening is not really improving. I still answer a lot of questions incorrectly.

Reading

A Answer these questions with a partner.

1. How many sections are there in the Reading Module?
2. How many passages will you have to read?
3. How many questions are there in total?
4. How long do you have to answer all the questions?
5. How are the texts in the Reading Module different from one another?
6. Do the texts gradually become more challenging?

B Answer these questions with the same partner.

1. What is the difference between **skimming** and **scanning**? Give an example of each.
2. What is the **source** of a text? Give an example.
3. What is the **function** of a text? Give an example.
4. What is **paraphrasing**? How could you paraphrase '*this question isn't so easy*'?
5. What do we mean when we say '*understand a new word or phrase in context*'?

C Give yourself a score out of five for the progress you are making with each of these reading skills.

skimming / reading for gist	___
scanning / reading for specific information	___
general reading speed	___
understanding new words and phrases in context	___
recognizing paraphrased language	___

D Tick the statement below that is true for you.

- A I am happy that my reading has improved since I started this course.
- B I don't think my reading has improved since I started this course.



Task-type tip: There are some listening and reading tasks that you haven't practised yet.

Writing

A Circle the correct option in these statements about the Writing Module of the IELTS exam.

1. You will have to write *one / two / three* compositions.
2. You have *30 minutes / one hour / two hours* to write the compositions.
3. In the first part of the Writing Module, you will have to *describe charts and graphs / write a story / write a letter*.
4. For the first part of the Writing Module, you must write *100 / 150 / 200* words.
5. In the second part of the Writing Module, you will have to *present an argument or express an opinion / describe a person or place / write a report*.
6. For the second part of the Writing Module, you must write *150 / 200 / 250* words.

B When you write, you must consider all of the points below. For now, which two points are most important? Tick them.

1. You must answer the question and make points that are relevant to the question.
2. You must make sure that what you write is grammatically correct.
3. You must use a range of vocabulary and choose the right words and phrases.
4. You must organize your composition so that the examiner can read it easily and understand what you want to say.
5. You must use the right number of paragraphs and the right linking words and phrases.
6. You must use the right register – your writing must be appropriately formal or informal.
7. You must make sure that all your spelling is correct.
8. You must make sure that all your punctuation is correct.

C Answer these questions with a partner.

1. Which of the two compositions is easier for you to write?
2. How long will you spend writing the first composition?
3. How long will you spend writing the second composition?
4. Do you write too much or not enough for the first composition? Why?
5. Do you write too much or not enough for the second composition? Why?
6. Is your writing improving? Tick the aspects of your writing that have improved recently.

- ☐ understanding the question and knowing what to write
- ☐ planning and noting down ideas
- ☐ organizing ideas
- ☐ using paragraphs
- ☐ linking ideas together
- ☐ using the right register
- ☐ using a wider range of vocabulary
- ☐ spelling
- ☐ punctuation

What next?

You've only completed a third of the course, so don't worry if you haven't improved all aspects of your English. There is plenty of time to learn more and practise the skills and tasks that you find difficult. Here are some things that you should do now. Decide which ones you'd like to do first. Number them.

- ☐ Find as many opportunities to speak English as you can. If you have friends or relatives who speak good English, practise with them once or twice a week. Practise with other students in your class when you have a break or after the lesson. Practise talking about the topics that you will have to talk about in the exam.
- ☐ If listening is difficult, ask to borrow CDs and listen at home or on the bus or train. Listen to English that is at your level to give you confidence, and listen to English that is a little more challenging so that you know what to expect in the exam. Listen to extracts which have a tapescript so that, after you listen, you can read and check what you didn't understand and why you didn't understand it.
- ☐ Read as much as you can. Borrow books from a library and read articles in magazines and newspapers. Try to read any letters or documents in English that are related to your job. Read texts that are at your level to give you confidence, and read texts that are a little more challenging so that you know what to expect in the exam. When you read, notice how the text is organized. Look at how paragraphs and topic sentences are used and how words and phrases are used to introduce ideas. Practise reading without a dictionary so that you can guess the meaning of new words and phrases in context.
- ☐ Note down new vocabulary and make sure you revise it. Note down words and phrases that will help you talk about what is important to you. Note down words and phrases that will help you in the reading and listening modules and words and phrases that you can use when you write. Check the word and phrase list for each of the units you have studied in the Course Book.
- ☐ Practise writing sentences and short paragraphs to improve your grammatical accuracy, spelling and punctuation. Write complete compositions to practise organizing and linking. Do the writing tasks in the Course Book and Workbook, and ask your teacher to give you more writing tasks if you need more practice. Look at model answers to exam questions and notice how students answer questions. When you learn important new words and phrases, make sure you remember how to spell them.

Go on to the next section of the Course Book. Make sure you practise all aspects of your English, but focus on what you are having problems with. Don't worry if you don't make progress in all areas at the same time. It is much easier to learn English if you enjoy it!

